

# The Sybil's Cave Proof

At 9:10 p.m., curator Miriam Quill failed to return from the restricted corridor. The glass case holding an alleged 1842 Poe proof packet is empty. The midnight ferry is the deadline: determine who falsified the record, where Quill is, and what evidence survives independent corroboration.

## Session procedure — 75 minutes

**0–10 minutes — Legend.** Read this briefing, introduce each role, and ask each person to distinguish direct observation from repetition. Release the Poe method note and the two source-history disclosures.

**10–35 minutes — Provenance.** Release the timeline, media report, and access log. At minute 25, if no one has challenged the proof, ask: 'Can an old clipping authenticate the note attached to it?'

**35–60 minutes — Rescue.** Release the tenant ledger, delayed voice message, and pump card. If the group identifies immediate danger—or reaches minute 50—read the pump card aloud and open the recess before continuing the accusation. Safety never depends on a suspect volunteering information.

**60–75 minutes — Resolution and debrief.** Require the group to name the fabricator, Quill's location, and at least one corroborated path. Then separate documented history, character testimony, physical evidence, and inference.

## Historical boundary

Mary Cecilia Rogers's body was recovered in the Hudson off Elysian Fields north of the cave in 1841. No reliable evidence establishes the cave as her murder scene. Edgar Allan Poe later transformed newspaper reporting about the unresolved case into \*The Mystery of Marie Rogêt\*.